

FIRESIDE VENTURES

ESG & Sustainability Platform

Company Founder's Guide

A comprehensive guide to understanding the platform,
your KPIs, and how ESG scores are calculated.

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1. Introduction & Platform Overview

The Fireside Ventures ESG & Sustainability Platform (Fireside KPI) is a comprehensive tool designed to help portfolio companies track, measure, and improve their Environmental, Social, and Governance (ESG) performance. The platform enables you to:

- Report quarterly and annual KPI data across ESG dimensions
- Benchmark your performance against sector and revenue peers
- Track your progress through percentile rankings
- Identify areas of strength and opportunities for improvement
- Generate insights that inform strategic decision-making

The platform is tailored to your company's specific industry (e.g., Food & Beverage, Beauty & Personal Care, Fashion & Lifestyle, etc.) and revenue stage, ensuring you only see KPIs relevant to your business.

2. Getting Started — Logging In

Access the platform at:

URL: <https://fireside.fandoro.ai/>

Your Login ID and Password are provided by the Fireside team. Each company has a unique Login ID (a short abbreviation of your brand name). Upon login, you will see your company's dashboard personalized with your brand name and relevant KPIs.

3. Company Dashboard Overview

Your dashboard is organized into several key sections:

3.1 Progress Report

Four stat cards at the top of your dashboard show your performance rankings:

Metric	Description
Overall Rank	Average of your Completeness, Consistency, and Timeliness percentile scores
Completeness	Percentage of assigned KPIs that have been filled for the selected period
Consistency	Ratio of KPIs filled this period vs. the previous period (measures ongoing reporting discipline)
Timeliness	Measures how promptly you submit your data within the reporting window

3.2 ESG Score Cards

Below the progress report, four ESG score cards are displayed:

- ESG Composite Score — Your overall weighted ESG percentile
- Environment Score — Your environmental/circular economy percentile
- Social Score — Your social impact and workforce percentile
- Governance Score — Your governance policies and practices percentile

3.3 View Modes

A toggle at the top of the dashboard lets you switch between:

- **Percentile View:** Shows your rank as a percentile (e.g., 72nd percentile)
- **Category View:** Shows a letter grade based on percentile bands:

Grade	Percentile Range	Meaning
AA	80th percentile and above	Top performer
A	60th – 79th percentile	Strong performer
BB	40th – 59th percentile	Average performer
B	20th – 39th percentile	Below average
C	Below 20th percentile	Needs improvement

4. Data Entry — Understanding Your KPIs

KPIs (Key Performance Indicators) are the data points you report through the platform. Each KPI has the following attributes:

Attribute	Description
ESG Category	Whether it falls under Environment (E), Social (S), or Governance (G)
Category	The broad thematic group (e.g., Employment, Packaging, Energy)
Core Level	Core 1 (mandatory for all) or Core 2 (additional depth indicators)
Period	Whether the KPI is reported Quarterly or Annually
Revenue Stage	Your applicable revenue bracket (₹0-50Cr, 50-100Cr, 100-500Cr, 500Cr+)
Industry	The internal industry classification that determines which KPIs apply to you

The platform auto-assigns KPIs based on your company's industry and revenue stage, so you only see what's relevant to you.

4.1 Auto-Save

All data entered is automatically saved as you type. You do not need to manually save your progress. However, you should use the Preview & Submit flow to formally submit your data for the reporting period.

5. KPI Categories & Feature Modules

Your KPIs are organized into feature modules, each representing a specific domain. Not all modules are applicable to every company — they depend on your industry and the features enabled for you.

5.1 Quarterly Modules

Module	What It Covers
Business Information	Revenue, EBITDA, ARR, and core financial metrics
Employment (Social)	Headcount by gender, contract type, leadership composition, pay parity
Packaging (Basic)	Total material used, recycled content, plastic breakdown, EPR/VPN compliance
Packaging (Detailed)	Secondary/tertiary packaging materials with granular breakdowns
Fashion Materials	Fiber composition, recyclable vs synthetic materials (Fashion companies)
Incidents & Grievances	Workplace incidents, PoSH cases, resolution tracking
Sourcing & Fulfillment	Vendor diversity, MSME dependency, DEI compliance in supply chain

5.2 Annual Modules

Module	What It Covers
Water Management	Water consumption, fresh water %, recycling rates across facilities
Energy Management	Energy consumption, renewable mix, facility-level breakdowns
Waste Management	Total waste generated, diversion rates, disposal methods
CSR	CSR spend ratio vs net profit, programme details
Governance Policies	Policy adoption (POSH, Whistleblower, Anti-Bribery, etc.), training coverage
Certifications	Product/service certifications and external reporting
Operations	Revenue analysis, approach & vision statements
SRI (Social Responsibility)	Sustainability initiatives, community impact
Health & Healthcare	Employee healthcare access and coverage

6. Performance Metrics

Your performance is evaluated on three dimensions, which together determine your Overall Rank:

6.1 Completeness

Measures how many of your assigned KPIs you have filled out.

- **Formula:** $(\text{Number of KPIs filled} \div \text{Total KPIs assigned}) \times 100$
- Only Core 1 and Core 2 KPIs assigned to your company are counted
- Feature-specific KPIs are included if the feature module is enabled for you

6.2 Consistency

Measures whether you maintain your reporting discipline over time.

- **Formula:** (KPIs filled this period ÷ KPIs filled last period) × 100
- A score of 100% means you filled the same number of KPIs as the previous period
- Scores above 100% (capped at 100 for display) mean you improved

6.3 Timeliness

Measures how promptly you submit data within the reporting window.

- Data submitted within the target window receives the highest score
- Late submissions receive progressively lower scores

6.4 Overall Rank

Your Overall Rank is the simple average of your Completeness, Consistency, and Timeliness percentile scores. This is then compared against all portfolio companies to determine your percentile position.

7. ESG Composite Score — How It's Calculated

The ESG Composite Score is a weighted average of your three pillar scores:

Pillar	Weight	What It Measures
Environment	35%	Circular economy, packaging, water, energy
Social	25%	Workforce diversity, pay parity, vendor DEI
Governance	40%	Policy adoption, training, board composition

ESG Composite = (Environment Score × 0.35) + (Social Score × 0.25) + (Governance Score × 0.40)

7.1 Weight Redistribution

If any pillar is N/A for your company (e.g., you don't have environmental data or the module isn't applicable), the weight is redistributed proportionally among the remaining pillars. For example, if Environment is N/A:

- Social weight becomes: $25\% \div (25\% + 40\%) = \sim 38.5\%$
- Governance weight becomes: $40\% \div (25\% + 40\%) = \sim 61.5\%$

7.2 Percentile Ranking

Your ESG Composite raw score is then ranked against all portfolio companies to produce a percentile (1st–99th). This percentile is what you see on your dashboard.

8. Environment Score (Circular Economy Index)

The Environment Score is calculated differently for Non-Fashion and Fashion companies.

8.1 Non-Fashion Companies

For companies in Food & Beverage, Beauty & Personal Care, Health & Wellness, Home & Décor, and Platform Enablers:

Component	Weight	What It Measures
Virgin Plastic Reduction %	20%	Year-on-year reduction in virgin plastic usage
Plastic Intensity (MT/₹Cr)	30%	Total plastic per crore revenue (lower is better — inverted)
Material Recycled %	20%	Percentage of total material that is recycled
max(EPR, VPN) %	10%	Higher of EPR compliance or Voluntary Plastic Neutrality
P&S Recycled/Pkg %	10%	Primary & Secondary recycled+sustainable materials as % of total
Recyclable %	10%	Percentage of primary packaging that is mono-material / recyclable

8.2 Fashion Companies

Component	Weight	What It Measures
Recyclable Materials %	40%	Percentage of materials that are recyclable
Recyclable Packaging %	40%	Derived from MT of recyclable vs non-recyclable packaging
Fresh Water Consumed %	10%	Facility-average fresh water as % of total consumed
Water Recycled %	10%	Facility-average wastewater recycled percentage

8.3 Normalization

Each component is normalized using min-max scaling across the eligible peer group (all portfolio companies in the same category):

- **Standard metrics:** The company with the highest value gets 100, the lowest gets 0
- **Inverted metrics (e.g., Plastic Intensity):** The company with the lowest intensity gets 100, the highest gets 0. A company with zero plastic usage receives the highest percentile.

The weighted sum of these normalized components gives your raw Environment Score, which is then percentile-ranked across all companies.

9. Social Score

The Social Score captures workforce diversity, equity, and supplier responsibility:

Component	Weight	How Scored
Supplier CoC In Place	10%	Binary: Yes = 100, No = 0
Supplier CoC Training	10%	Binary: Yes = 100, No = 0
DEI Vendor %	10%	Percentile-normalized across companies
Gender Ratio	25%	Female-to-total employee ratio, percentile-normalized
Women in Leadership	25%	Women in senior/CXO roles, percentile-normalized
Pay Parity	20%	Male-to-female pay ratio (closest to 1 = best), percentile-normalized

9.1 Sourcing Feature Redistribution

If your company does not have the Sourcing & Fulfillment feature enabled, the three sourcing-related metrics (Supplier CoC IP, CoC Training, DEI Vendor) are marked N/A and their combined 30% weight is redistributed:

- Gender Ratio: ~35.7%
- Women in Leadership: ~35.7%
- Pay Parity: ~28.6%

10. Governance Score

The Governance Score evaluates your company's policy framework and board-level practices. Key components include:

- **Policy Adoption Rate:** The percentage of governance policies your company has adopted out of the standard set (POSH, Whistleblower, Anti-Bribery, Data Privacy, ESG Policy, Code of Conduct, etc.)
- **Training Coverage Rate:** The percentage of relevant policies for which employee training has been conducted
- **Board Composition:** Diversity and independence metrics of the board of directors

Each component is percentile-normalized and the weighted score determines your Governance percentile rank.

11. Company Rankings & Percentile Bands

On the admin dashboard (visible to the Fireside team), all portfolio companies are ranked and grouped into five bands based on their percentile scores:

Band	Percentile	Description
AA	80th and above	Top-tier ESG performers; exemplary reporting and practices
A	60th – 79th	Strong performers with consistent ESG engagement
BB	40th – 59th	Average performers; on track with room for improvement
B	20th – 39th	Below average; attention needed on key ESG metrics
C	Below 20th	Needs significant improvement; immediate action recommended

Your company's dashboard shows your percentile position and/or letter grade. All rankings are calculated dynamically against the current portfolio of invested companies.

11.1 Benchmarking

When you click on any ESG score card, a drill-down chart shows three bars:

- **Your Percentile (Blue):** Your company's percentile rank
- **Sector Average (Green):** Average percentile of companies in your industry sector
- **Revenue Cohort Average (Amber):** Average percentile of companies in your revenue stage

12. Dashboard Drill-Downs & Insights

Clicking on each ESG score card opens a detailed dialog showing:

- **Bar Chart:** Visual comparison of your percentile vs sector and revenue cohort averages
- **Component Breakdown (ESG Composite):** Shows the weighted contribution of Environment (35%), Social (25%), and Governance (40%) to your overall score
- **View Toggle:** The Environment, Social, and Governance drill-downs show Annual view data, while Quarterly view filters out annual-only metrics

Note: Each KPI score has a different weightage, determined internally by Fireside, and is not equally distributed.

13. Data Submission & Preview

Before formally submitting your data:

1. Navigate to the **Data Entry** section and fill in all applicable KPIs
2. Use the **Preview & Submit** page to review all entries before submission
3. Once submitted, the data is locked for the reporting period
4. You can also upload data via Excel template using the **Upload** section

Data can also be uploaded in bulk via the Excel template available for download from the platform.

14. Support & Contact Information

For any questions, data clarifications, or technical issues:

Contact	Role	Email
Tarak Doshi	Data & ESG Queries	tarak@firesideventures.com
Smita Mishra	Technical Support	sm@fandoro.com

You can also raise a support ticket directly from within the platform using the Help & Support section.

15. Glossary of Terms

Term	Definition
ESG	Environmental, Social, and Governance — the three pillars of sustainability assessment
EPR	Extended Producer Responsibility — regulatory obligation for producers to manage post-consumer waste
VPN	Voluntary Plastic Neutrality — voluntarily offsetting plastic footprint through certified programmes
P&S Recycled/Pkg	Primary & Secondary Recycled Packaging — sum of sustainable materials as a percentage of total packaging
CEI	Circular Economy Index — the Environment Score metric measuring material circularity
GHG	Greenhouse Gas — emissions contributing to climate change (CO ₂ , methane, etc.)
DEI	Diversity, Equity & Inclusion — vendor and workforce diversity metrics
SRI	Socially Responsible Investing/Initiatives — sustainability and community impact programmes
KPI	Key Performance Indicator — a quantifiable metric used to track performance
MIS	Management Information System — the scorecard/PDF report summarizing your ESG performance
CSR	Corporate Social Responsibility — voluntary initiatives for social and community benefit
POSH	Prevention of Sexual Harassment — statutory policy requirement for Indian

	workplaces
CoC	Code of Conduct — a formal set of ethical guidelines for suppliers/vendors
MSME	Micro, Small & Medium Enterprises — classification of supplier businesses by size
PwD	Persons with Disabilities — workforce inclusion metric
EBITDA	Earnings Before Interest, Taxes, Depreciation, and Amortization
ARR	Annual Recurring Revenue — annualized recurring subscription revenue

Email Methodology: Sector Avg & Revenue Cohort Avg

How the ESG Performance Email calculates benchmark averages

1. General Calculation Methodology

1.1 The Building Block — cohortPercentile(value, allValues)

Every company's raw score (e.g. circularEconomyIndex = 45.2) is first converted to a **percentile rank** within the full eligible cohort:

1. **Sort** all scores in the cohort ascending.
2. **Find** the first index where score $\geq$ value.
3. **Calculate:** percentile = round(((index + 1) / n) × 99), clamped to 1–99.

1.2 Sector Avg (by Industry)

For each ESG pillar (Environment, Social, Governance, Composite):

1. **Filter** the eligible pool to companies sharing the same industry as the target company.
2. **Compute** each company's cohortPercentile against the full cohort (not just the industry group).
3. **Average** those percentiles → Sector Avg.

Formula: Sector Avg = mean(cohortPercentile(companyScore, fullCohort)) for each company where industry = target industry

1.3 Revenue Cohort Avg (by Revenue Stage)

Same logic, but grouped by revenue stage instead of industry:

1. **Filter** to companies with the same revenue stage.
2. **Compute** each company's cohortPercentile against the full cohort.
3. **Average** → Revenue Cohort Avg.

Formula: Revenue Cohort Avg = mean(cohortPercentile(companyScore, fullCohort)) for each company where revenueStage = target stage

1.4 Special Rules

- **Environment pillar:** the eligible pool is further filtered to companies with hasEnvironmentFeature = true.
- **Social & Governance:** use all submitting companies (those with at least one KPI entry).

- **ESG Composite:** same pattern using esgCompositeScore pool.
- **Rounding:** results are rounded to whole numbers via Math.round().

2. Example — ABC (Social Score)

Company: **ABC** | Industry: **Health & Wellness** | Revenue Stage: **500+**

Step 1 — Build the full cohort pool

Collect the raw Social Score (socialScore from insights) for every submitting company. Example with 18 companies:

Company	Social Score
Company A	22.5
Company B	35.1
Company C	41.0
ABC	58.3
Company D	60.2
...	...
Company R	89.4

Step 2 — Convert each score to a percentile

Sort all 18 scores ascending. For each company, find its index and compute:

```
percentile = round(((index + 1) / 18) × 99)
```

If ABC's score of 58.3 is at index 10 (0-based) in the sorted array:

```
ABC's percentile = round((11 / 18) × 99) = round(60.5) = 61
```

Step 3 — Sector Avg (Industry = Health & Wellness)

Filter to companies in the same industry. Say there are 3 companies in "Health & Wellness":

Company	Social Score	Percentile (full cohort)
ABC	58.3	61
Company X	42.0	44
Company Y	71.5	78

```
Sector Avg = mean(61, 44, 78) = round(61) = 61
```

□ *Key point: each company's percentile is calculated against the full cohort of 18, not just the 3 in the industry. Then those percentiles are averaged.*

Step 4 — Revenue Cohort Avg (Revenue Stage = 500+)

Filter to companies with the same revenue stage. Say there are 5 companies at "500+":

Company	Social Score	Percentile (full cohort)
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ABC	58.3	61
Company M	35.1	28
Company N	60.2	67
Company P	80.0	83
Company Q	45.0	50

Revenue Cohort Avg = mean(61, 28, 67, 83, 50) = round(57.8) = 58

What appears in ABC's email (Social Score chart)

Metric	Value
Your Percentile	61st
Sector Avg	61
Revenue Cohort Avg	58

The same process repeats for Environment (using only env-eligible companies), Governance, and ESG Composite.